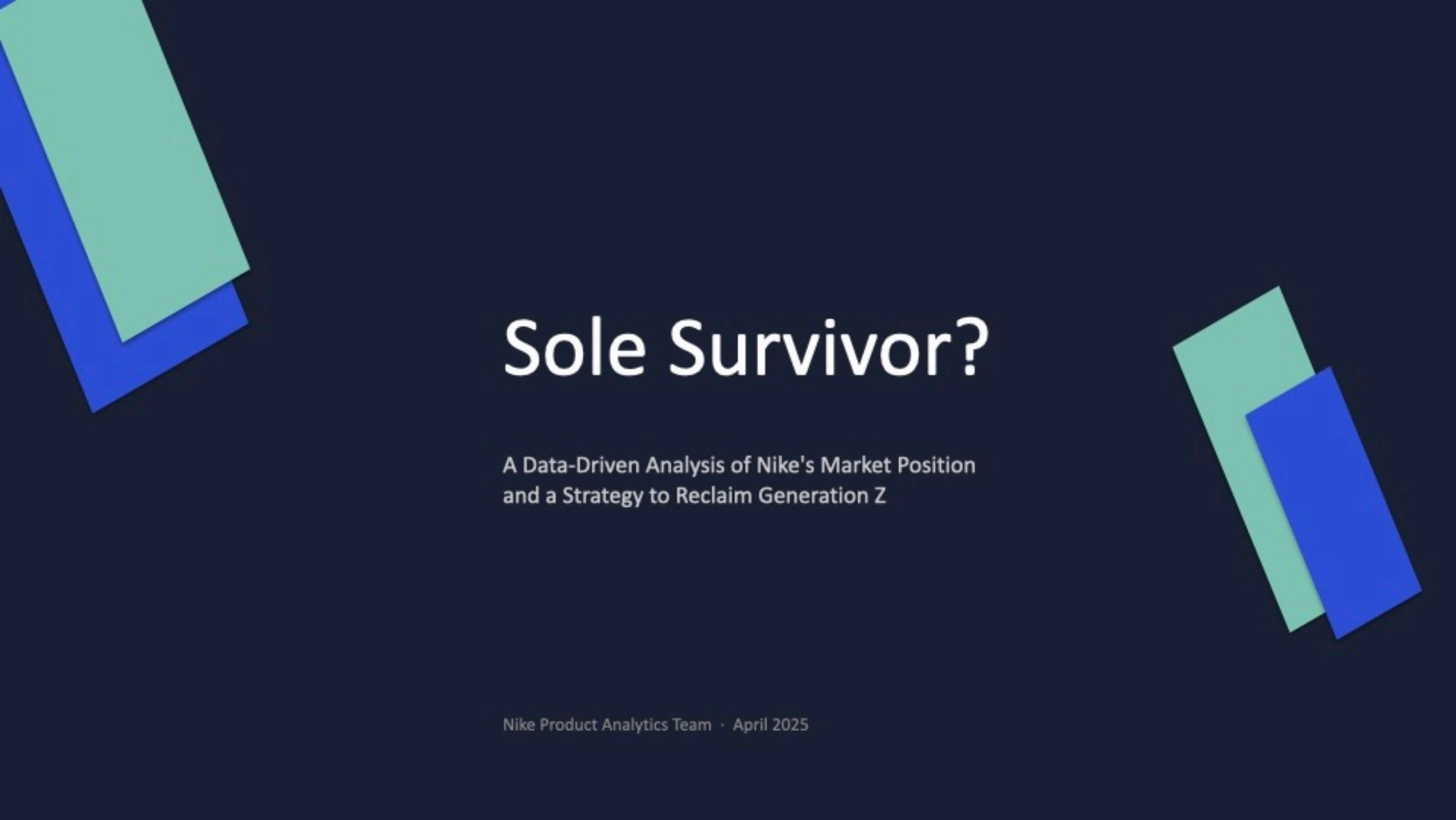




Sole Survivor?

A Data-Driven Analysis of Nike's Market Position
and a Strategy to Reclaim Generation Z

Nike Product Analytics Team · April 2025

The Ground Is Shifting Under Nike's Feet

-2%

Nike 5yr search interest

+138–183%

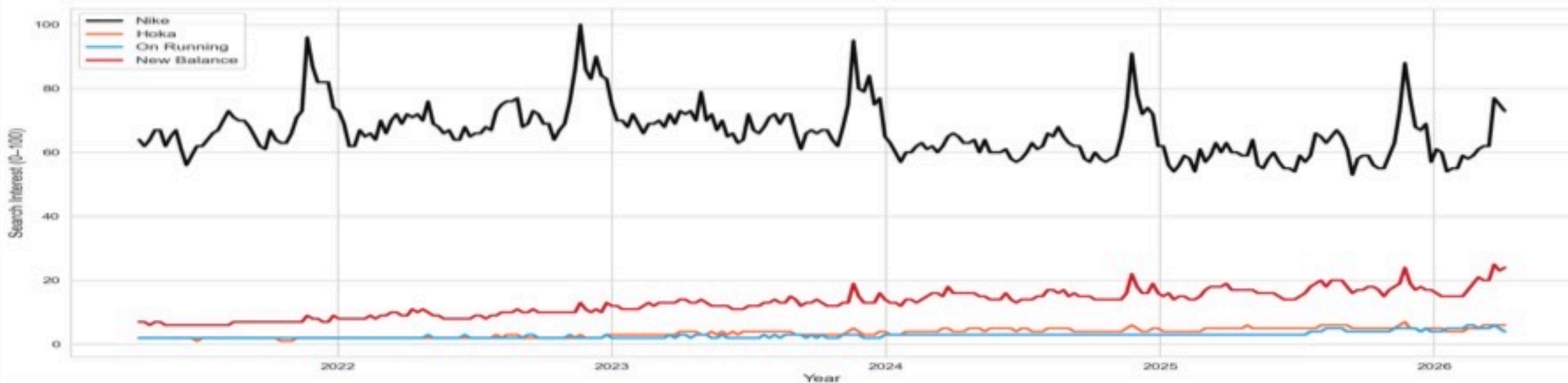
Challenger brand growth

-10%

Nike revenue growth 2025

For the first time in decades, Nike is the only major athletic brand that is shrinking.

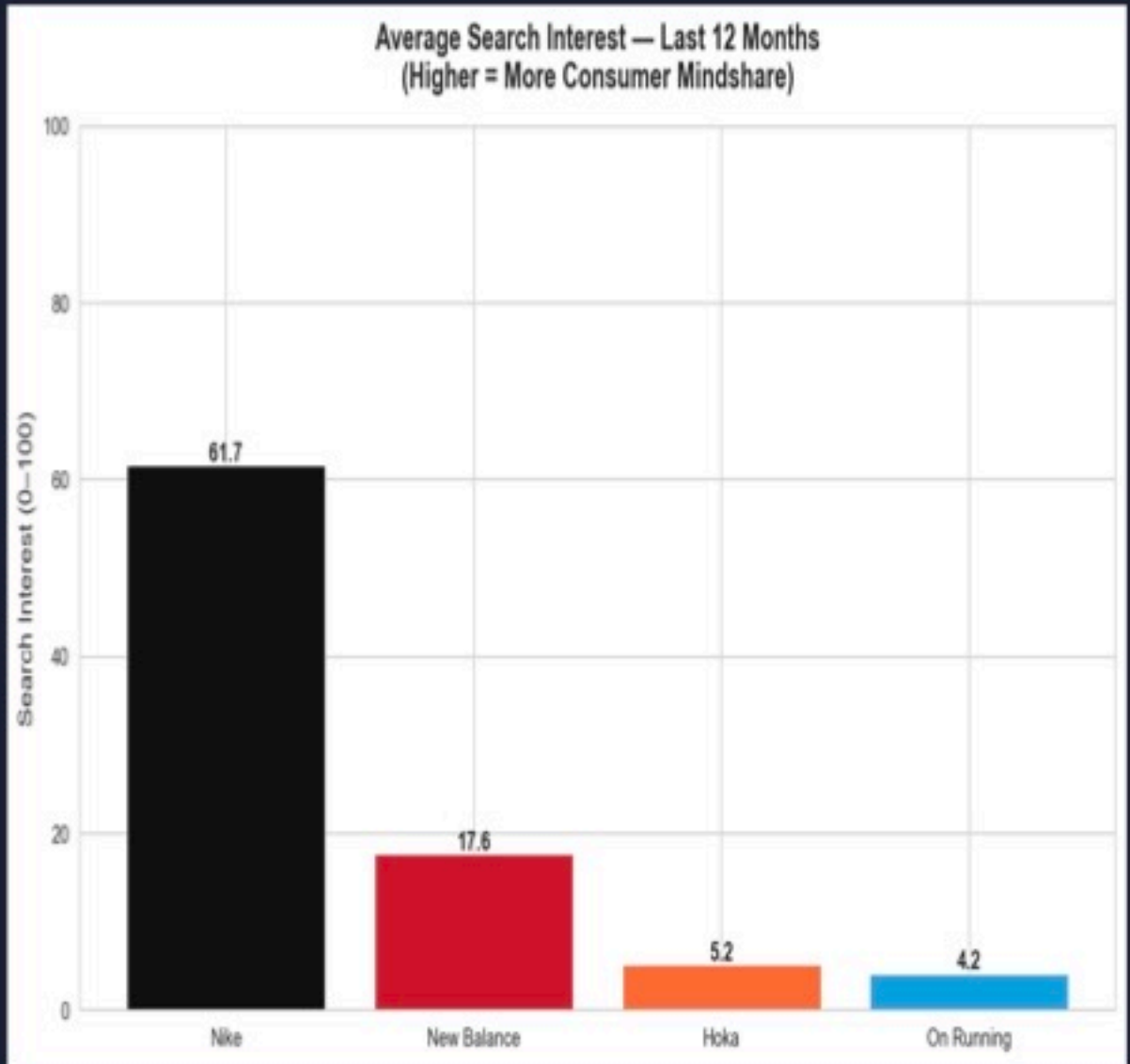
Brand Search Interest Over Time (2020–2025)
Nike vs. The Challengers



The Global Athletic Footwear Market

- Global market: \$115B in 2024 → projected \$200B by 2030
- Nike market share: ~27% — down from 35% in 2019
- Fastest growing: Performance Running & Lifestyle
- Key challengers: New Balance, Hoka, On Running, Adidas

Nike's share of a GROWING market is falling — a compounding crisis.



Meet the Brands Eating Nike's Lunch

NEW BALANCE

+183%

search interest (5yr)

\$3.3B → \$7.0B

revenue

Owns the GenZ casual space

HOKA

+160%

search interest (5yr)

\$3.2B → \$5.0B

revenue

Owns performance running

ON RUNNING

+138%

search interest (5yr)

\$1.2B → \$3.0B

revenue

Owns premium aspirational

All three grew revenue 58–147% while Nike declined.

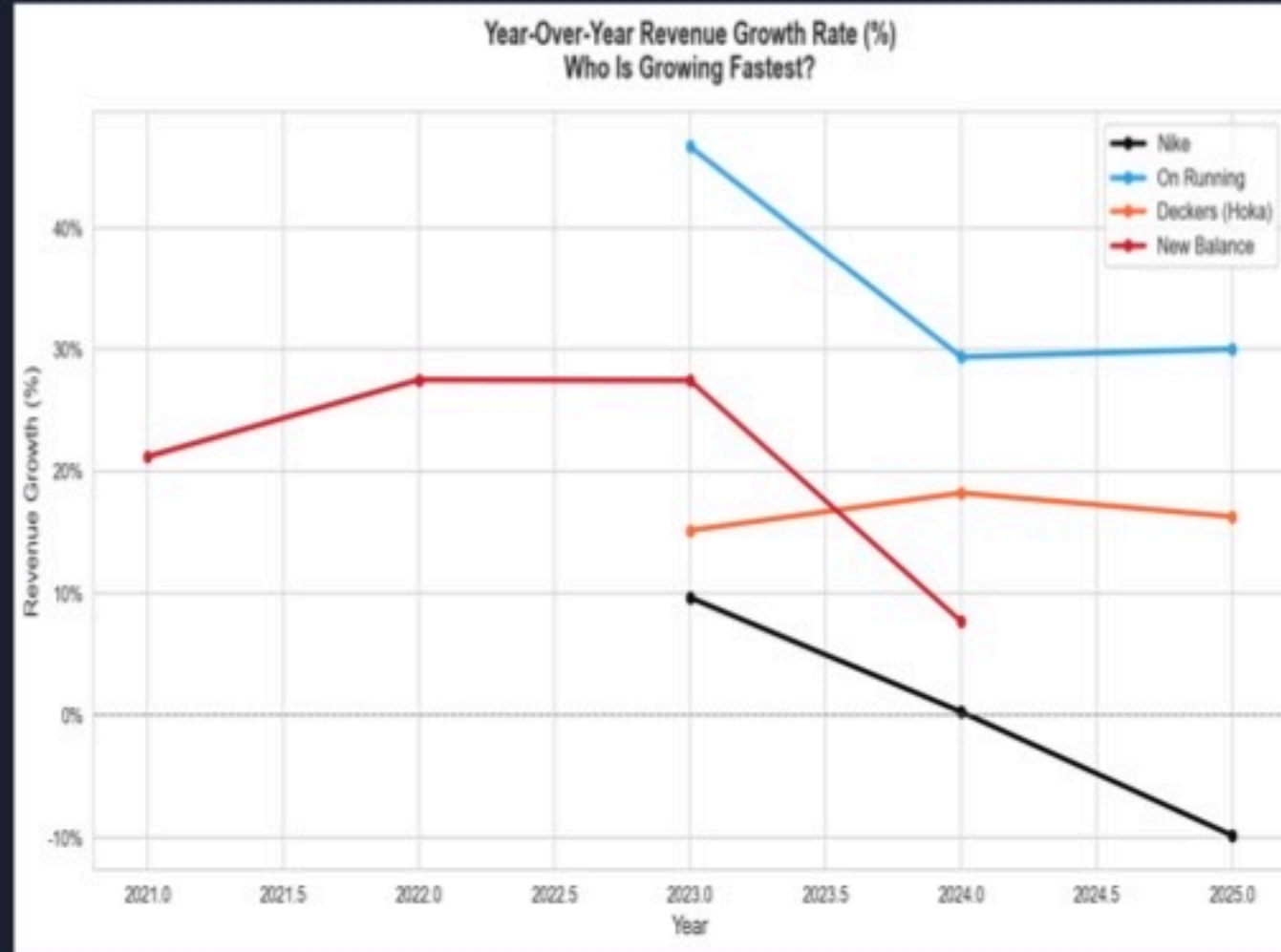
Nike By The Numbers: A Brand in Decline

Revenue is shrinking.

Nike posted -10% revenue growth in FY2025 — its steepest decline in over a decade. Every challenger brand grew 15–30% in the same period.

Client Implications:

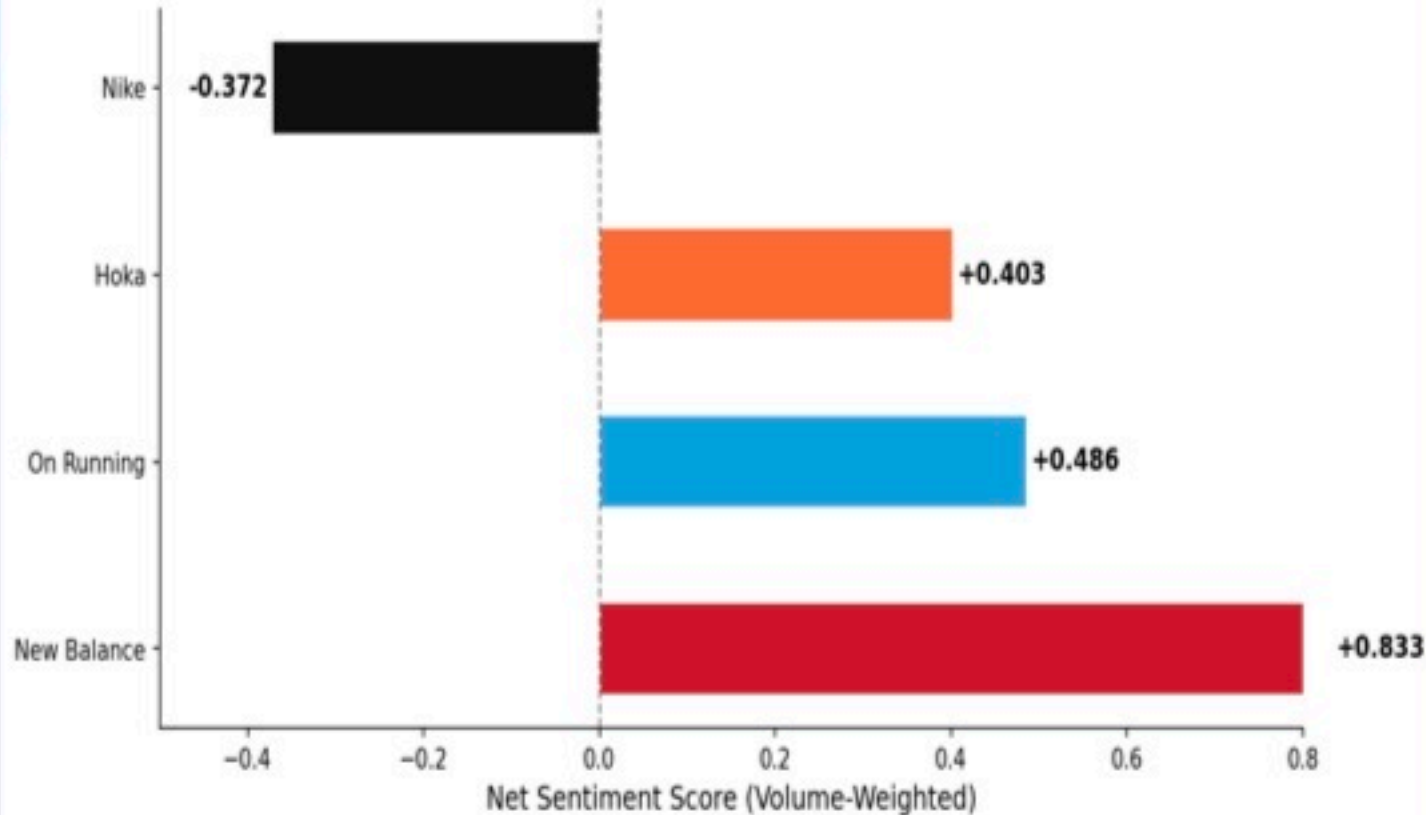
- Nike is losing ground in its core markets
- Challengers are accelerating while Nike retreats



Nike crossed below 0% growth in 2024 — the only brand in the room going backwards.

What Consumers Are Actually Saying

Consumer Sentiment Score by Brand
(Reddit, Amazon Reviews & Running Forums)



KEY FINDING

Nike is the **ONLY** brand with negative consumer sentiment.

-0.372

Nike

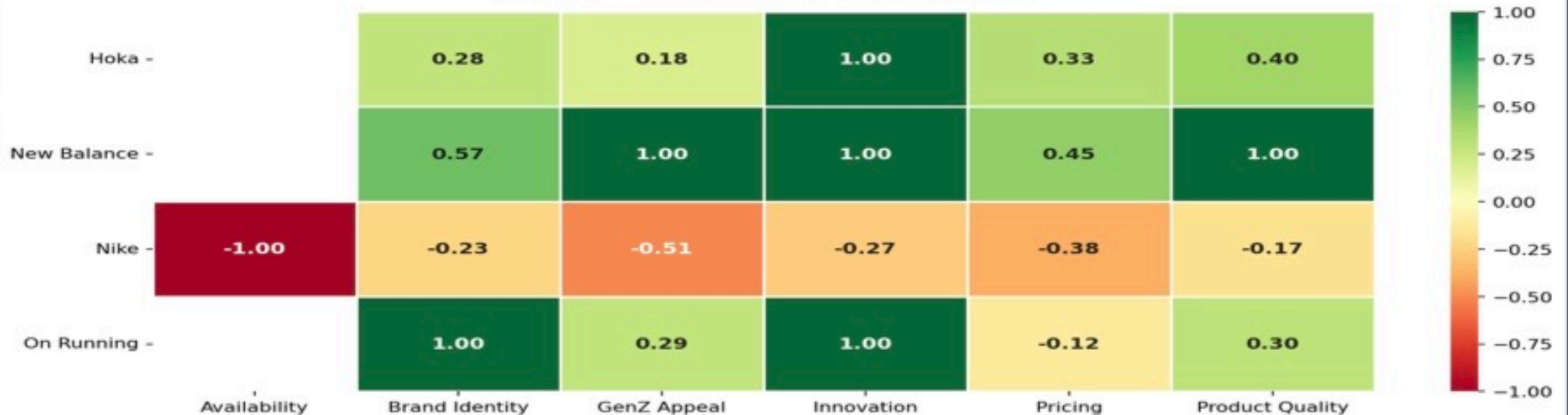
+0.833

New Balance

Reddit, Amazon Reviews, Running Forums - 38 themes

Category-by-Category: Where Nike Is Failing

Consumer Sentiment Heatmap by Brand & Category
(Green = Loved, Red = Pain Point)



GenZ Appeal -0.51

GenZ sees Nike as their parents' brand — #1 pain point by volume

Availability -1.00

Bots and resellers destroyed the community drop culture

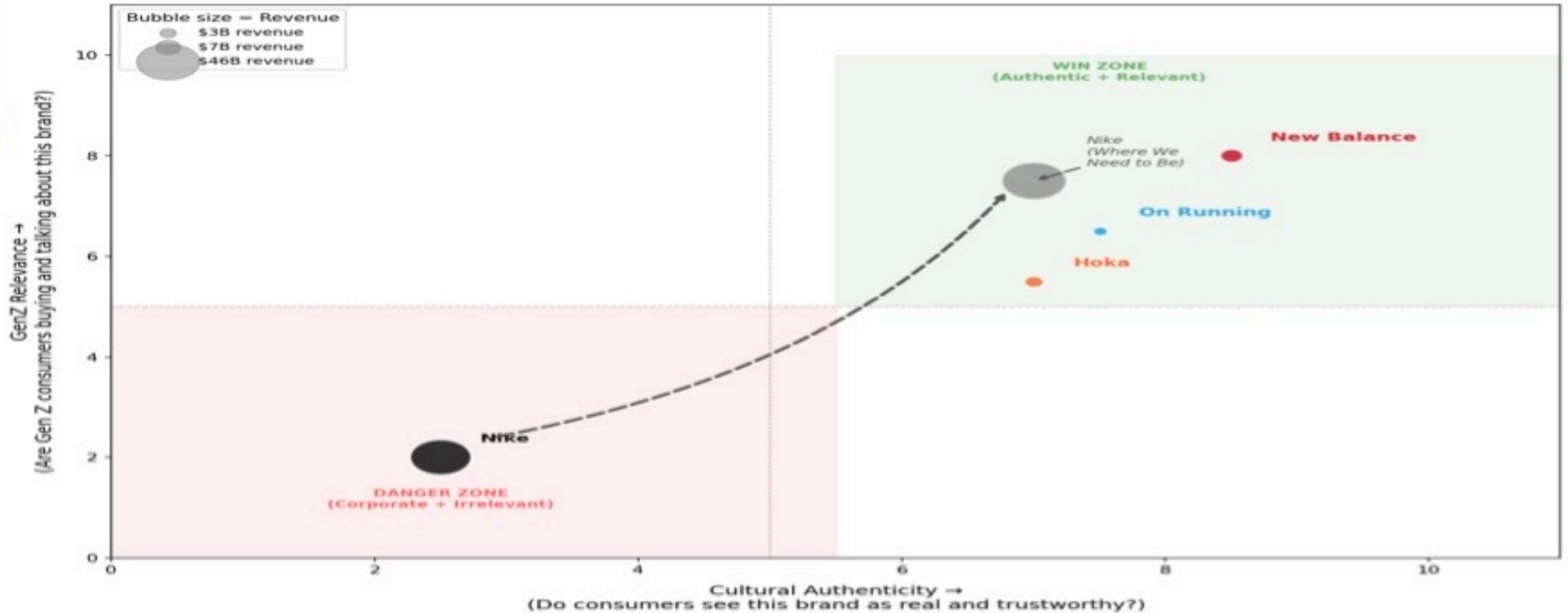
Pricing -0.38

Too expensive for the quality consumers are getting

The Opportunity: Nike Is in the Wrong Zone

Every competitor has moved to the Win Zone. Nike sits alone in the Danger Zone.

Brand Positioning Map: Cultural Authenticity vs. GenZ Relevance
Nike needs to move from Danger Zone → Win Zone



Path forward: Earn back cultural authenticity — the one thing money alone cannot buy.

"Nike Reborn" — A 3-Pillar GenZ Strategy

Data-Driven. Culture-First. Community-Led.

"NIKE REBORN" — A 3-Pillar GenZ Strategy Data-Driven. Culture-First. Community-Led.

PILLAR 1 Community-First Drops

*Pain Point: Availability score -1.00
"Bots & resellers killed the culture"*

- Verified local buyer program
- In-store community access
- Anti-bot authentication
- 60% of drops reserved for real Nike community members

KPI: Community drop sell-through
Target: 80% to verified locals

PILLAR 2 GenZ Co-Creation

*Pain Point: GenZ Appeal score -0.51
"Nike feels like my parents brand"*

- Nike Design Lab platform
- GenZ designers submit concepts
- Community votes on top designs
- Winners get produced & credited
- 12 community drops per year

KPI: Platform submissions & votes
Target: 500K GenZ designers by Y2

PILLAR 3 Cultural Partnerships

*Pain Point: Brand Identity score -0.23
"Feels corporate, lost its cool"*

- Partner with underground artists
NOT mainstream celebrities
- Sponsor local sports culture:
street football, skate, dance
- Pull back from mass advertising
- Let the product speak first

KPI: Earned media & UGC volume
Target: 40% increase in organic posts

Community-First Drops

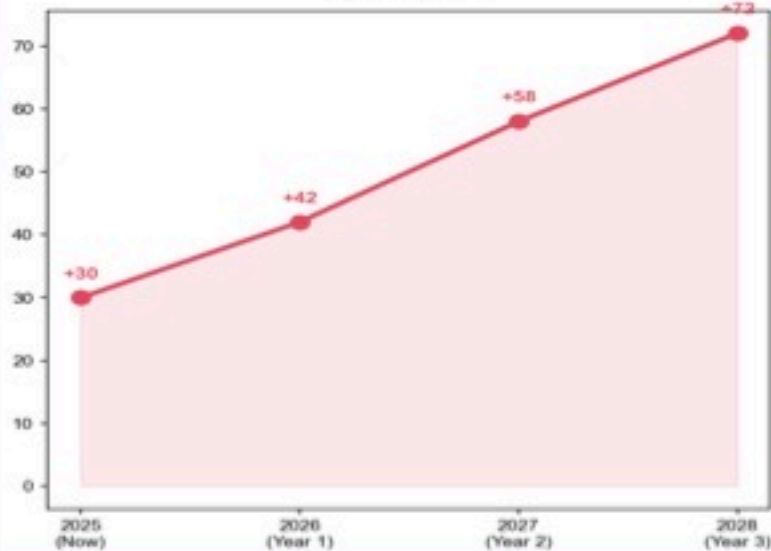
GenZ Co-Creation

Cultural Partnerships

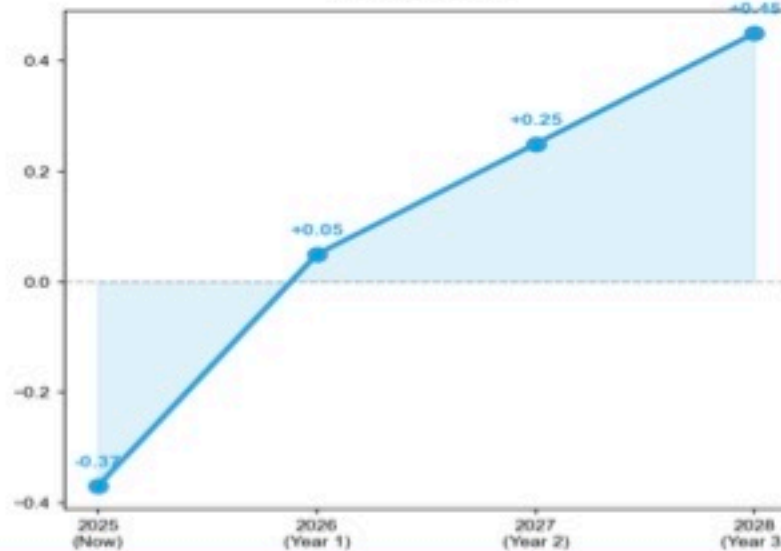
If We Execute: A 3-Year Roadmap Back to Growth

"Nike Reborn" — Projected Impact Over 3 Years
(If Strategy Executed Fully)

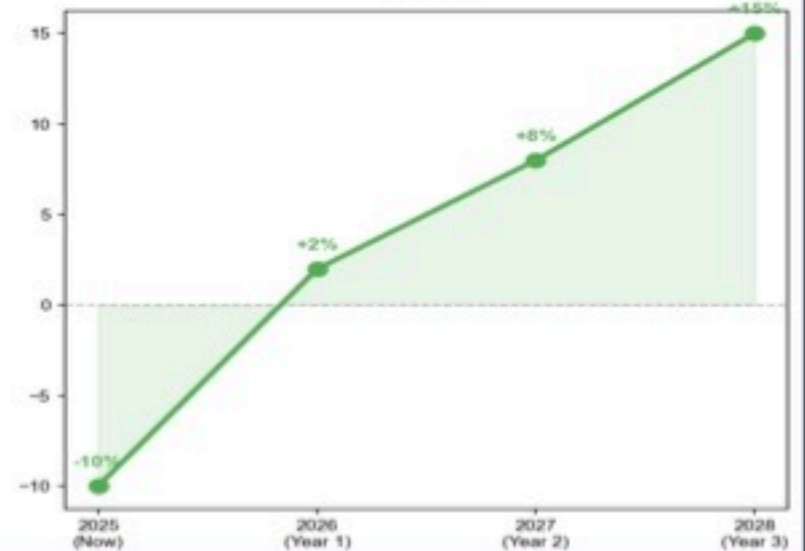
GenZ Search Interest
(Index Score)



Consumer Sentiment
Score (-1 to +1)



Revenue Growth
Rate (%)



GenZ Search Index

30 → 72 (+140%)

Consumer Sentiment

-0.37 → +0.45

Revenue Growth

-10% → +15%

"Nike doesn't need a new shoe. It needs a new relationship with the next generation."